

What borders couldn't divide

Listen...

the wandering breeze
knocks softly,
carrying *Sita's* sigh,
like a whispered secret.

She once filled my courtyard
with laughter,
when days felt endless.

We grew beneath the same sky,
didn't we?

Evenings dissolved into color,
as if they would
never fade.

If my land still glows
in gentle sunlight,
I can't help but wonder...
hers must too.

Tell me,
O wandering breeze,
does the wind I know
still pass through her streets?

Does it hum
those old lullabies,
the ones we never knew
we were learning?

And the sun
that finds me each morning,
does it reach her
the same way?

Spilling gold
across her world,
as though nothing
ever changed.

There are borders now.
Miles stretched
into silence.

Paths that once knew us
have forgotten our names.

But the earth beneath us
has not changed.
The sky above,
still vast,
still patient.

And sometimes,
in the quietest moments,
it feels as though
nothing is truly divided...

only held apart
by something
the heart refuses to accept.

Sita and ***Saba***.

Two names
echoing each other,
like a memory
that will not fade.

These are not just stories,
they are fragments of a life
my grandmother still carries.

When she speaks
of her childhood,
her voice softens,
warms...

as if she is stepping
back into it.

You can see it in her eyes,
in the lines upon her face—
that land,
that soil,
that belonging
she never left.

In the rhythm of *qawwali* (music),
the entire village
swayed as one.

Whether the sweetness of *Eid's halwa*
or *Diwali's laddoos* (festival sweets),
everything was shared freely,
beyond every divide.

She tells me about *Sita*,
how they ran through days
never knowing
what separation meant.

Two girls
under one sun,
never asking
who belonged where.

She remembers
the scent of *saag* simmering,
drifting through the village—

no doors,
no permission,
as if every home
shared the same rhythm.

And Sita would come,
carrying *makki di roti*,
with butter soft and bright,
melting
before it touched the plate.

For love lived in the smallest things,
in food,
in joy,
in pain.

Simple things...
yet somehow,
everything.

They did not “share” food.
They simply ate together.

Laughed.
Reached across
without thinking.

There was no mine or yours,
only ours.

Strange, isn't it?
How something so small
can hold more love
than words.

She says even now,
that fragrance has not left her,
still alive,
somewhere within.

Time moved on.
Lines were drawn.
Maps rewritten.

And suddenly,
what was once whole
was declared torn.

But some things
do not listen to maps.

Childhood does not.
Love does not.
Memory does not.

What they had
no distance
could erase.

Maybe that is what
she has been telling me all along.
lands may be divided,
roads may disappear,
people may be torn apart...

but what was once shared,
deeply,
truly remains.

Quietly.
Stubbornly.
In the heart.

Because I remember too,
how she once laughed
in my courtyard,

when childhood felt endless,
painted in warmth
and shadow.

Two souls,
bound together
by memory
and pain.

We are made
of the same earth.

Neighbors of one heart.

Born of the same mother,
raised in the fragrance
of the same soil,
living beneath
the same shadow of pain.

Your children are hungry;
mine carry
the same sorrow.

Searching for bread
in the same way,
writing the same story
of tomorrow.

Why all these slogans?
Why these endless fights?

Where love could have blossomed,
why plant
seeds of spite?

Let us live in peace...
do not force us to fight.

You are not a stranger.
Nor am I.

We are reflections
behind the same mask.

Borders may divide us...
but hearts
are never torn apart.

We are still the same people,
who understand
each other's silence,
who recognize
each other's pain,
who carry
the same stories.

And somewhere,
between memory
and longing,
between earth
and sky...

we are still together.

